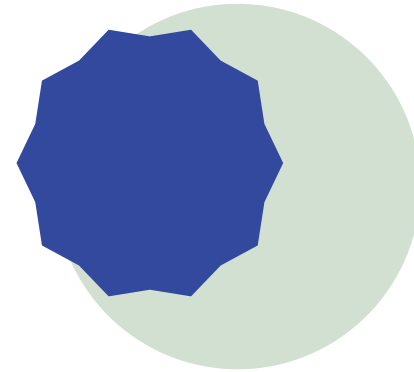
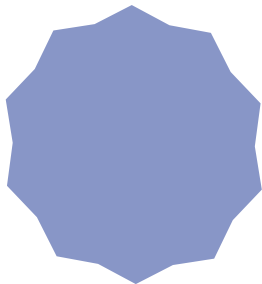




Words I Used (The Series)

Ava Erickson



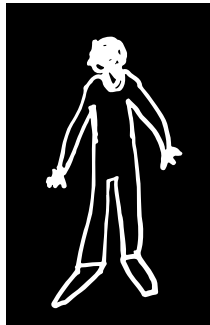
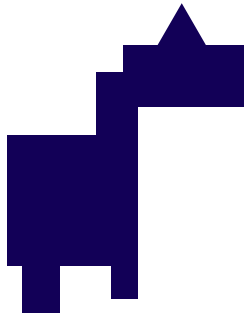
Ava Erickson
Roger Williams University
Senior Thesis Capstone

Art Direction, Fall 2023
Graphic Design Communications,
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Arts, and Education*



Words I Used (The Series)

An exploratory series on experimental design and written word



FROM THE AUTHOR:

I hope you are inspired by my creations and assortment of poetry. This project had many contributors, most who wanted to remain anonymous. Many of these poems are written by students ages 10-20. I want to thank each of them for sharing their work and allowing me to design the space in which their work resides. I want to thank Roger Williams University and Professor Denielle Emans for giving me the opportunity to practice experimental design.

I want to thank Sir Bernard Moshe Ben Avraham Kelley for his guidance and written contributions as well, I am honored to have an award winning poet featured in my first collection.

Special thanks to Newport County Prevention Coalition for their community efforts and dedication to mental health awareness and suicide prevention.



ABOUT

Words I used is a poetry booklet series aimed at youth engagement and mental health awareness. By creating visual graphics and using intricate typography styles the poetry featured in these booklets are shown in a different light.

Influences from the world around us changes how we see the world and how we feel about things. By using experimental type and design I have created identities for the poems featured in each zine style booklets, informing youth about creative expression and its relation to mental health.

The investigations create the final products of publications. These booklets presented in zine style will feature poems and written words from youth writers and local award-winning poets.

BACKGROUND & ABSTRACT

The education of mental health awareness and mental well-being is important for everyone but needs to be further applied in children and young adults. This cohesive project will combine technological talents, writing skill, and design skill with real-world experiences and stories of individuals who have struggled and are struggling with mental health issues. This will occur in a collaborative and creative way to ensure a powerful outcome is achieved.

I have always had an interest in compiling something, especially something tangible. By designing the contents of each page and the order of the pages overall I feel that I will be able to achieve the manifestation of something that can be enjoyed by a variety of viewers but will relate most to today's youth.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

TOPIC AND DIRECTION

My journey with research first began with the RI non- profit I work for, Newport County Prevention Coalition. NCPC is a organization that focuses on healthy living. Some of the most prevalent issues that they help with is; drug addiction, prevention, suicide prevention, homelessness prevention, and family resources. I gathered some data about arts enrichment and the benefit of arts and how it helps children deal with trauma and mental health problems. From the beginning, I wanted to help bridge resources to youth and find out a beneficial way to reach a constantly growing audience. Eventually I narrowed down my ideas and decided to focus on three different investigations that all are interconnected with certain design elements and topics, but stand out enough on their own to feature a general theme and idea. These themes include but are not limited to; color relation and how the brain recognizes relation and patterns in design, and the relation of written word and design.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

ZINE-SPIRATION



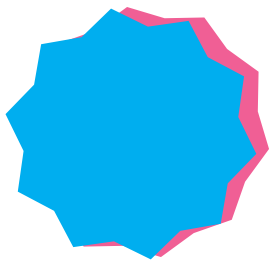
Exploring themes of
nostalgia and childlike
wonder

INVESTIGATION 1

CHILDHOOD

For my first investigation I wanted to explore big concepts with familiar scenery. I chose poems that revolve around growing up, learning from life, and about finding who you are. I wanted the first in the series to feel welcoming and safe.

Design Method: Bold, bright gradients, patterns and colors.





INVESTIGATION 2

PUNK **EDITION**

For the second edition of the zine, I wanted to explore a cultural interest of mine which is the punk rock culture of the 90s. I researched the musical influence that sparked the punk movement that began in the 70s. The poems I curated for this selection are meant to reflect the designs in a non-traditional way. Exploring more harsh and anti-establishment designs made me want to know how youth will engage with these concepts paired with written poetry.

Design Methods: Punk : Use of half tones, bold colors, edgy symbols. These concepts slashed with harsh topics. Stories of loss and love, trials and triumphs. The literal sense of grittiness is explored as well as poetic symbolism.

PUNK
PUNK

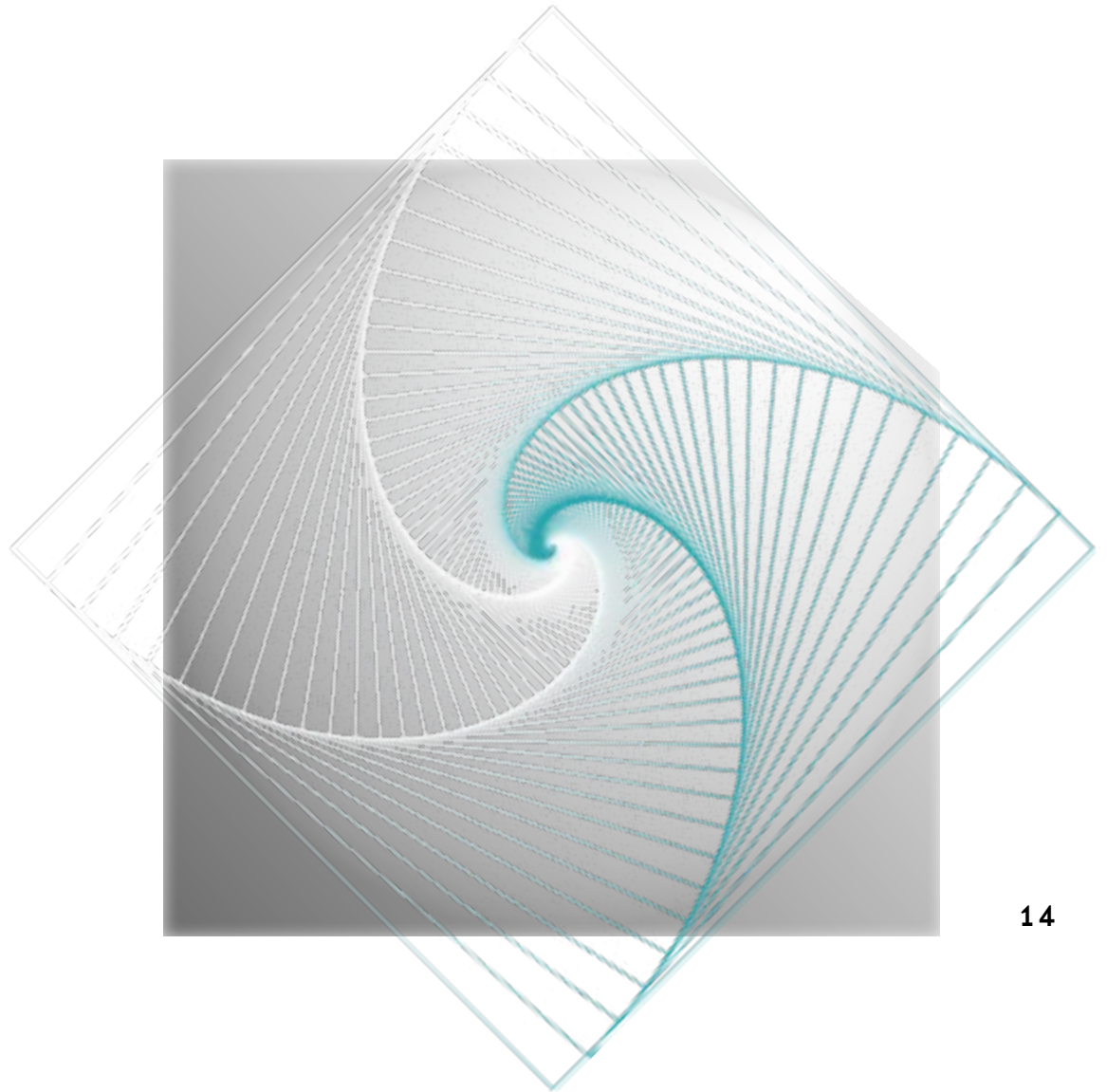




For my third investigation I wanted to explore relationships and how we connect with each other in this world. By using symbols that reflect interconnectedness, I expressed these emotions and feelings with lots of spirals and loose imagery. The poems involve themes of who we are as people and how design connects us all. The title “contract” describes how human feelings and emotions are always changing.

INVESTIGATION 3

CONTRACT





For God's Sake Delete This

This poem of mine is fleeting
and really needs deleting
I'm strong in cheap writing
and will I keep repeating
"this poem of mine is fleeting."

My words are like spigots
or simpled up caskets,
with thoughts you might wish poetry
and/or vagueness not guilty,
produced or even pretty.
So for all humanity
delete this poem thoughtlessly
before it brings calamity
with rhymes of pure anxiety
like vanity of musicians.

This poem of mine was fleeting
and its need of quick deleting
or you'll end up in cheap writing
repeating and repeating
"this poem of mine is fleeting
and really needs deleting"

In Dreams

Practically all pieces of you,
as the night quickly makes its
as the only one I can find pieces,
as a world where you're not right beside me.

Keeping me that, taking responsibility of you,
your amazing ways till the world,
about that sleep tonight about those memories,
when I'm concerned for how much you can.

You, who makes everything that right,
with your laughter that echoes in my heart,
and the way you care for me,
makes every waking second feel like a gift.

So, I let myself drift into dreams,
where we're together, unbreakable,
in this quiet night, you see my everything,
the way I look for in the stars.

And when morning comes, I remember,
the dreams where I held you close,
knowing that each night, I'd find you again,
in the quiet space of my shared dreams.

You spend the day with things,
but by simply being you,
in your arms, all my worries fade away,
like shadows at daybreak.

In dreams, I find you again,
a love so deep, it makes caring for you worth it,
yes, I fight the pull of sleep,
just to keep thinking of you a little longer.

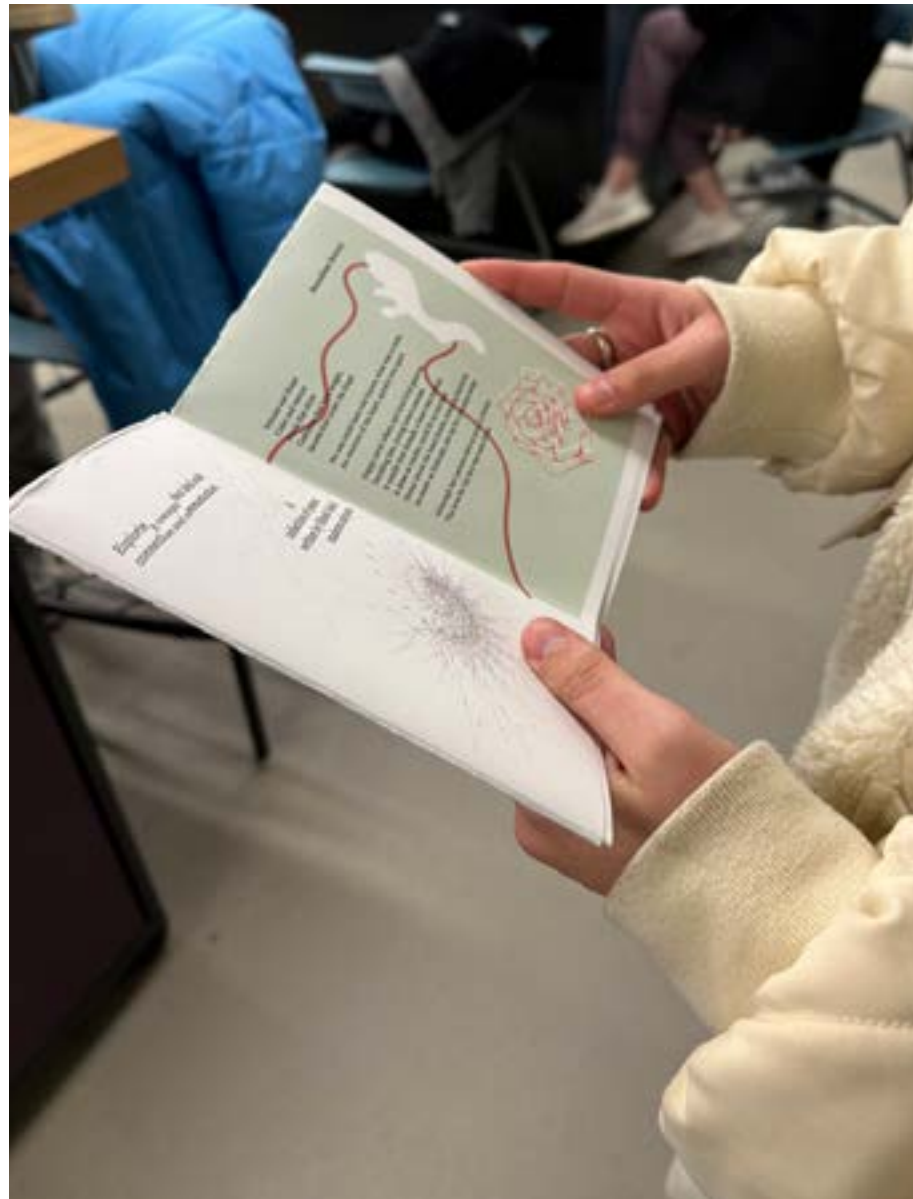
FINDINGS

THE REAL WORLD
AND THE FUTURE,
WHATS NEXT?

Creating hard copy books. Most likely a publication with all three investigations (series) and even additional sections.



I received a lot of positive feedback from viewers. My biggest challenge posed and faced was having a connection with the audience of these poems. A lot of viewers said that they related to the material, I still want to continue on with the series and see what more can be achieved. Overall I am proud with the design and style of the zines. I feel that i succeeded with the approach and type of publication



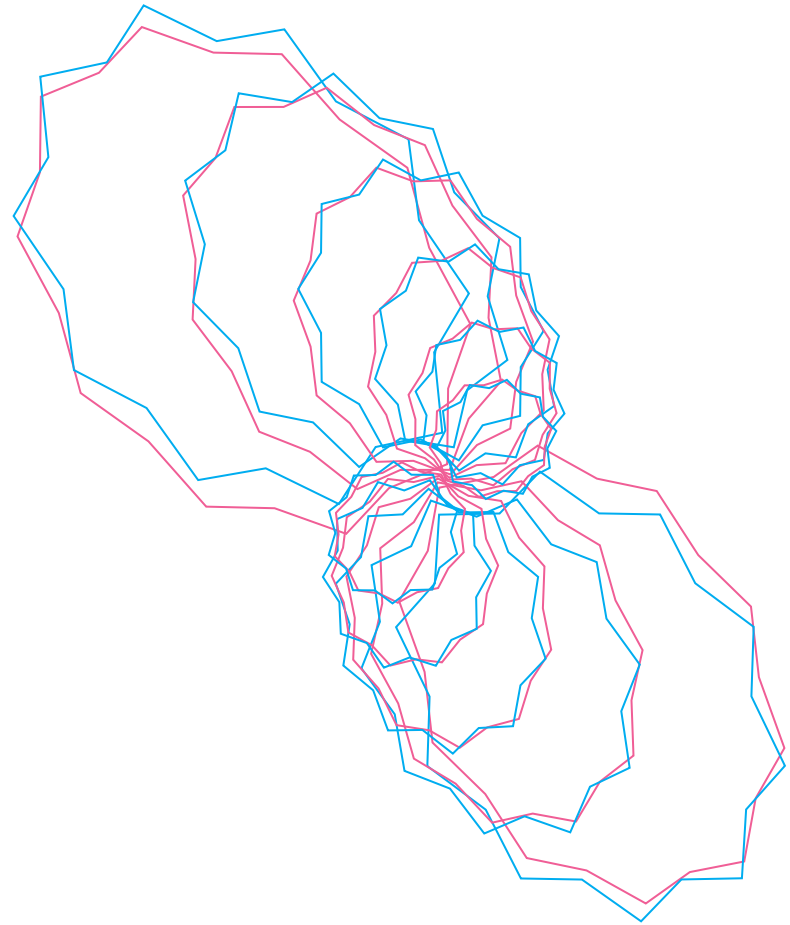




GLOSSARY

ZINE -short for magazine; specially : a noncommercial often homemade or online publication usually devoted to specialized and often unconventional subject matter.

EXPERIENTIAL GRAPHIC DESIGN -involves the orchestration of typography, color, imagery, form, technology, and especially content to create environments that communicate.



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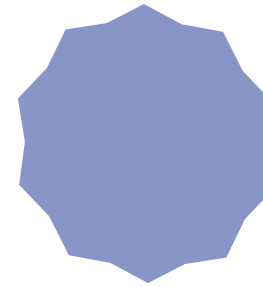
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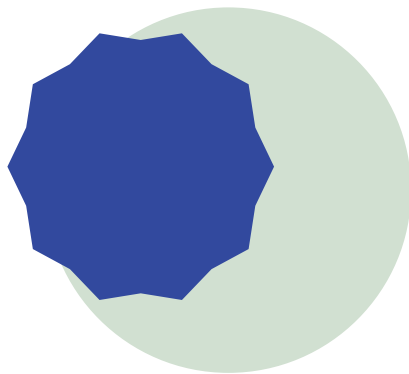
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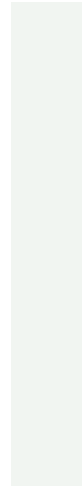
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Ava Erickson

Think outside
of shapes
and barriers.
They exist to
make you do so.



Always prioritize your mental
wellbeing and remember to
listen and to breathe.

